

END OF LIFE Abhishek K Kaiho's registered vehicle scrapping facility at Fatehpur, Haryana. Established with Japanese collaboration, the unit currently processes only some 200 vehicles per month against its capacity of around 1,800

vehicles. This, when its implementation could take around 12 million old and polluting vehicles—or about 4 per cent of the total 330 million vehicles—off India's roads in one fell swoop. Government data say older vehicles pollute 10-12 times more than new ones.

What It Means

Once the scrapping policy kicks in, owners of private vehicles—run on diesel and petrol—will have to put their 15-year-old cars, motorbikes and other vehicles to a stringent test at fully automated testing stations (ATS), which, among other things, will measure the pollutants the vehicles are emitting (see *How a Testing Facility Works*). This will enable them to get a fitness certificate for their vehicle for another five years. Currently, re-registering a 15-year-old vehicle requires manual inspections by state transport officials. Commercial vehicles, on the other hand, will have to undergo a fitness test every two years for the first eight years and every year thereafter, again at the ATS. If the vehicles fail the test, they will be termed end-of-life vehicles (ELV) and the owners can choose to scrap them but only in authorised scrapping facilities. Hence the term 'voluntary'.

The vision is that the old vehicles will make way for brand new, "fit" vehicles, which are safer, have better fuel economy and can therefore reduce the country's overall air pollution. There is only one problem. States have been taking their own sweet time to even start, forget accelerating the policy. Their tardy progress has prompted the Centre to hold monthly review meetings. "Every state has its own system," says Anurag Jain, secretary, ministry of road transport and highways (MoRTH). "In these interactions, we have started seeing some green shoots. Now we are bringing in the

AIMS OF THE POLICY

What the Voluntary Vehicle Fleet Modernisation Programme hopes to achieve

- Scrap some 12 million vehicles without valid fitness and registration. It will lead to 15-20% reduction in emissions due to vehicular pollution
- Enhance road, passenger and vehicular safety
- Improve fuel efficiency and reduce maintenance cost for vehicle owners
- Formalise the currently informal vehicle scrappage industry
- Boost auto sector sales and generate employment
- Promote availability of low-cost raw materials for automotive, steel and electronics industry

Polluting Wheels

Vehicles being targeted for scrapping



4.5 mn

OLD MEDIUM/ HEAVY VEHICLES

One old truck pollutes as much as 14 new trucks/ buses/ trailers



7.5 mn

OLD TAXIS/ CARS

One old taxi/ car pollutes as much as 11 new cars/ taxis

Source: Ministry of Road Transport and Highways